

One of the most wonderful gifts that nature has provided man with, is the ability to forget. However heavy the blows are that life metes out, time mostly finds a way of healing the wounds. The most tragic situations and happenings fall sooner or later into forgetfulness. Only eighteen years have passed since the Second World War and yet few people think now of the horrors of those times and of the miseries of millions of sufferers. The enemies of those times have become our friends. Names that were on the lips of all are unknown to the young people of today, and the dead have joined the dead of all the wars of history.

And yet there is a small group of people who could not forget: Jews out of all the lands of Europe, who lost their parents, children and brothers, and often witnessed the annihilation of their family. They have remained Hitler's "lifelong" victims. They owe their survival to some chance happening, some error or some miracle, but many of them came to think that they had not been lucky to have avoided the fate of their families. Many are now broken in soul and also even in mind. To the authorities of their new homeland Israel they pose a heavy problem.

A large organisation has been formed to care for these "lifelong" victims of Hitler. It is called the "Malben" organisation, and their purpose is to give to these lost and broken people a new outlook that will give them back their self-respect and a purpose in living.

Most of these victims are old people, and the "Malben" organisation has built for them several small villages that have little in common with the homes they left behind. The inhabitants of the "Malben" villages are not only cared for but are encouraged to work and to occupy themselves in busy activity. A method of "work therapy" is systematically used and great patience and understanding is required on the part of the doctors and helpers and authorities to bring these lost souls out of their lethargy, into which the tragic circumstances of their lives have brought them.

Former professors and artists are encouraged to work at a laundry press or in the fields. Some, like the tailor of the Rumanian royal court, are able to take up their old trade or profession. For some of them the feeling and knowledge that they can once again perform a useful task for the community is like a revivifying medicine.

Far more tragic is the situation of the many who are mentally sick. Great efforts are made for them, and wonderful improvements and recoveries have been recorded. But there are many whose madness is beyond repair, who continue to live